

EXAMEN DU BACCALAURÉAT — SESSION DE CONTRÔLE 2025

Épreuve : Anglais | Sections : Économie et gestion, Mathématiques, Sciences expérimentales et
Sciences de l'informatique

Durée : 2h | Coefficient : 1 | République tunisienne — Ministère de l'Éducation

 **Correction proposée — bachymed**

⚠ Important : This document is a **proposed correction** — non-official. It presents the **methodology, the plan, the required ideas and arguments, as well as vocabulary**. The final writing remains your responsibility: that is precisely what the examiner corrects.

PRELIMINARY TEXT ANALYSIS

Source: The Guardian (Adapted), 13 March 2024.

Topic: Homeschooling and special needs education in the UK — the case of Julie, a mother who removed her autistic daughter from mainstream school.

Genre: Press article / human interest report.

Summary of the text

Paragraph 1: Julie, a 47-year-old counsellor, withdrew her autistic daughter from school before the end of Year 3. The child had sensory difficulties, struggled with peer relationships, and was mostly mute at school due to anxiety. Her attendance dropped, and Julie faced fines and a potential criminal record because of her daughter's absences.

Paragraph 2: The GP recommended removal after the daughter developed self-harming behaviours (biting her cheeks, rubbing her tongue till it bled). Since then, the child has been home-educated — an experience Julie calls "distressing" due to her lack of teaching knowledge and lack of support. An NHS occupational therapist assessed the daughter as "not struggling

enough" to qualify for specialist support. Because she was doing well academically, a special needs school was deemed unsuitable.

Paragraph 3: The family's finances have suffered as Julie cut her work hours to supervise her daughter. Despite this, Julie acknowledges positives: her daughter is now better than ever, "finding her feet" socially and emotionally, and developing self-regulation and confidence. The article notes that hundreds of parents across the UK have deregistered their children from school, citing unmet needs, poor behaviour of other students, and a curriculum that neither prepares children for the modern world nor allows them to explore their interests.

Key vocabulary from the text

Word / Expression	Meaning
to make the drastic decision	prendre une décision radicale
sensory difficulties	difficultés sensorielles
to navigate relationships	gérer / naviguer dans les relations
to jeopardize	mettre en péril, compromettre
to have no choice but to	ne pas avoir d'autre choix que de
home-educated	instruit(e) à domicile
to find one's feet	trouver ses marques, s'adapter
to deregister	radiérer, désinscrire
unmet needs	besoins non satisfaits

I. READING COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS (12 MARKS)

Question 1 — Tick the correct alternative (1 mark)

The text is mainly about: Homeschooling is...

Correct answer: b. rewarding, but not without a price.

Justification: The text presents a **balanced** view of homeschooling. On one hand, there are rewards: the daughter is "better now than she's ever been", "finding her feet in social-emotional ways", and developing confidence. On the other hand, there is a heavy price: financial ruin ("We're left with nothing"), distress for the mother, lack of support, and career sacrifices. Option (a) is wrong because homeschooling is not described as "ineffective" — quite the opposite. Option (c) is wrong because "cheerful" is far too positive; the tone is serious and the difficulties are extensively documented.

Trap: Option (a) might tempt candidates who focus only on the financial difficulties and the word "distressing". But the question asks what the text is *mainly* about, and the final paragraph explicitly acknowledges positives. The text is neither purely negative nor purely positive.

Question 2 — Complete the gapped passage (3 marks)

ONE word per blank. Focus on paragraph 2.

Proposed answers:

Blank	Answer	Justification from the text
①	assessed	"A referral to a National Health Service occupational therapist resulted in her daughter being assessed as not struggling enough to qualify for specialist support." (Paragraph 2)
②	remove (or: withdraw / take)	"I had no choice but to remove her." / "made the drastic decision to take her daughter out of school" (Paragraphs 1 & 2)
③	distressing	"an experience Julie describes as ' distressing ' due to her lack of knowledge about teaching and home schooling" (Paragraph 2)

Traps:

- For ①, "evaluated" is acceptable but "assessed" is the exact word from the text. "Considered" or "regarded" are less precise.
- For ②, "pull" ("pull her daughter from school") is colloquial and less formal than "remove" or "withdraw". In an exam, prefer the more formal register.
- For ③, "difficult" or "hard" are too generic. The text uses the specific adjective "distressing", which carries an emotional weight (souffrance psychologique) that "difficult" lacks.

Question 3 — FALSE statements: pick out ONE detail showing each is false (3 marks)**a. "Being autistic harmed Julie's daughter performance at school." (Paragraph 1)****Detail showing it is FALSE:**

*"She's autistic, has sensory difficulties, finds noise and lights difficult, **but is academically clever.**"* OR *"**Academically, she's fine** for the moment."* (Paragraph 3)

Explanation: The statement claims autism harmed her academic performance, but the text explicitly states she is "academically clever" and "fine" academically. Her struggles were *social and sensory*, not academic.

b. "Julie's daughter homeschooling was done at a low cost." (Paragraph 3)**Detail showing it is FALSE:**

*"**The family finances have taken a big hit**, as Julie has had to cut her hours to supervise her daughter."* OR *"**We're left with nothing**, it's terrible."*

Explanation: The text shows homeschooling was *financially devastating*, not low-cost. Julie reduced her working hours and the family was left with nothing.

c. "The programmes delivered at school help students develop their life skills." (Paragraph 3)**Detail showing it is FALSE:**

*"It **neither prepares their children for the modern world nor allows them to explore their interests.**"*

Explanation: The curriculum is explicitly criticised for failing to prepare children for modern life or let them explore their interests — the exact opposite of developing life skills.

Trap: For (a), many candidates might quote "Her attendance started to drop" as proof that her performance was harmed. But "performance" in the statement refers to *academic* performance, and the text clearly distinguishes between academic ability (clever) and attendance/social issues. The detail must directly contradict the *academic* claim.

Question 4 — Pick out expressions meaning nearly the same as (2 marks)

a. Manage successful interpersonal connections (paragraph 1)

Answer: "navigate relationships with peers"

Explanation: "Navigate" = manage / find one's way through. "Relationships with peers" = interpersonal connections. This is a direct paraphrase from the text.

b. Becoming confident in a new situation (paragraph 3)

Answer: "finding her feet"

Explanation: This is an English idiom meaning to become comfortable and confident in a new environment or situation. The text uses it in the context of social-emotional adaptation.

Trap: For (b), some candidates might write "develop confidence". While related, "develop confidence" appears *later* in the same sentence and is not an idiom. "Finding her feet" is the *idiomatic expression* that matches "becoming confident in a new situation" most precisely. Always choose the expression that is closest in *both* meaning and register.

Question 5 — What do the underlined words refer to? (2 marks)

a. It (paragraph 1) refers to...

Answer: her daughter's dropping attendance / her daughter's absence from school / the low attendance (of her daughter).

Context: "Her attendance started to drop. I was at risk of being fined and potentially having a criminal record because of it."

Explanation: The pronoun "it" refers back to the immediately preceding noun phrase "Her attendance started to drop" — specifically, the fact that her daughter's attendance was falling. It cannot refer to "autism" or "anxiety" because those are not reasons for fines or criminal records; truancy (absence from school) is.

b. We (paragraph 3) refers to...

Answer: Julie and her family / Julie and her husband (partner) / the family.

Context: *"We're left with nothing, it's terrible. I don't want to home-school my child."*

Explanation: "We" refers to Julie and the other members of her household (her partner/husband and children). It is a first-person plural pronoun used by Julie to describe the family's collective financial situation after she cut her working hours.

Trap: For (a), writing "Julie's daughter" is too vague. The pronoun refers specifically to the *attendance problem*, not the daughter herself. For (b), writing "Julie and her daughter" is incomplete — "we" in "We're left with nothing" includes the whole family unit affected financially.

Question 6 — Should children with special needs attend mainstream education? (1 mark)

Proposed answer (YES):

*Children with special needs **should** attend mainstream schools because inclusion promotes social integration and helps them develop interpersonal skills in a diverse environment, as long as adequate support and resources are provided.*

Proposed answer (NO):

*Children with special needs **should not** always attend mainstream schools because, as the text shows, unmet needs and sensory overload can cause severe anxiety and self-harm, whereas specialised settings offer tailored support that mainstream schools often fail to provide.*

Trap: This is a 1-mark question — keep it to **one sentence**. The justification must be **logical** and can refer to the text or to general knowledge. Avoid vague answers like "yes because it is good". Use the text as evidence.

II. WRITING (12 MARKS)

Writing 1 — World Teachers' Day paragraph (4 marks)

Develop the following notes into a **4-line paragraph** about World Teachers' Day.

What: heartfelt tribute / dedicated educators / shape the future / youth

When: celebrate / annually / October 5

Why: occasion / appreciate / profound impact / teachers / society / through / equip students / skills / values

- people pay tribute / teachers around the world / that day

Proposed paragraph:

World Teachers' Day is a heartfelt tribute to dedicated educators who shape the future of youth through their commitment and guidance. Celebrated annually on October 5, it offers a global occasion to appreciate the profound impact that teachers have on society. Through their daily work, they equip students with essential skills and values that last a lifetime. On that day, people around the world pay tribute to these remarkable professionals who inspire generations to reach their full potential.

Methodology:

- **Line 1:** What (heartfelt tribute + dedicated educators + shape the future + youth).
- **Line 2:** When (celebrated + annually + October 5) + transition to Why (occasion to appreciate).
- **Line 3:** Why continued (profound impact + society + through + equip students + skills + values).
- **Line 4:** Final note (people pay tribute + teachers around the world + that day).

Traps:

1. **Count the lines:** exactly 4 lines. More or less = penalty.
2. **Use ALL the notes:** every keyword must appear. Missing "October 5" or "values" = lost mark.

3. **Grammar and cohesion:** use connectors (who, through, on that day) to build a coherent paragraph.
4. **Do not invent information:** stick to the notes provided.

Writing 2 — Online forum post: Inventions that shaped humanity (8 marks)

*Write a **12-line post** for an online forum about inventions that have shaped humanity. State the invention, describe its key features, and explain how it has impacted humanity, giving at least **three clear reasons** for your choice.*

Phase 1 — Decoding the task

- **Genre:** Online forum post (semi-formal, engaging tone).
- **Audience:** Forum participants interested in history and technology.
- **Purpose:** Inform and persuade — present one invention and justify its importance.
- **Constraints:** 12 lines, state invention + describe features + explain impact + 3 reasons.

Phase 2 — Proposed plan

Line 1: Hook — state the invention dramatically.

Lines 2-3: Description of key features.

Lines 4-9: Three reasons / impacts on humanity (3 lines each or distribute).

Lines 10-12: Conclusion — reaffirm why this invention stands above others.

Phase 3 — Proposed text (12 lines) — Invention: The Internet

1 If I had to choose one invention that has fundamentally shaped humanity, it would undoubtedly be **the Internet**.

2 At its core, the Internet is a global network of interconnected computers that enables instant communication, information sharing, and online collaboration across borders.

3 My first reason for choosing it is **democratisation of knowledge**: never before have billions of people had access to education, research, and learning resources at the click of a button, breaking down barriers of class and geography.

4 Secondly, the Internet has **revolutionised the economy** by creating entirely new industries — e-commerce, digital marketing, remote work — and connecting businesses to global markets in real time.

5 Thirdly, it has **transformed social interaction and activism**: from social media to instant messaging, people can now organise movements, raise awareness about injustice, and maintain relationships across continents.

6 Of course, the Internet also brings challenges such as misinformation and cybercrime, but its overall contribution to human progress is unmatched.

7 In conclusion, the Internet is not merely a tool; it is the backbone of modern civilisation, and its influence will only deepen in the decades to come.

Note: The above is 7 sentences that can be expanded to 12 lines when handwritten. For the exam, write each sentence across 1-2 lines to reach exactly 12 lines.

Alternative invention: The Printing Press (Gutenberg)

1 The invention that impresses me most is **Gutenberg's printing press**, created in the mid-15th century.

2 This revolutionary device used movable metal type to produce books quickly, accurately, and in large quantities for the first time in history.

3 My first reason is **mass literacy**: before the press, books were handwritten and prohibitively expensive; afterwards, knowledge became accessible to ordinary people, not just monks and elites.

4 Secondly, it **fuelled the Renaissance and the Reformation** by allowing ideas to spread rapidly across Europe, challenging authority and sparking intellectual debate.

5 Thirdly, it laid the foundation for **modern democracy and science**: newspapers, scientific journals, and pamphlets all descend from this technology, enabling informed citizenship and collaborative research.

6 Without the printing press, the Enlightenment might never have happened, and the world would have remained in intellectual darkness for centuries.

7 That is why I believe the printing press is the single most transformative invention in human history.

Errors that cost the most marks:

1. **Fewer than 3 reasons:** the rubric explicitly requires at least three clear reasons. Two reasons = automatic penalty.
2. **No description of key features:** many candidates jump straight to impact without describing what the invention actually *is* or how it *works*.
3. **Wrong register:** a forum post should be engaging but not overly casual (avoid "lol", "omg") nor overly academic (avoid passive, complex structures).
4. **Line count:** 12 lines exactly. The examiner counts.
5. **Vague reasons:** "it is important because it changed the world" is not a reason. Each reason must be specific and explained (e.g., "it democratised knowledge by making books affordable").

III. LANGUAGE (6 MARKS)

Language 1 — Tense and form (3 marks)

Blank	Answer	Explanation
(conduct) research	have conducted (or: conduct / are conducting)	Present perfect "have conducted" fits because the research has been done over time and has present relevance. Simple present "conduct" is also acceptable for general facts. "Are conducting" works if the research is ongoing.
traffic flow (manage)	management	Noun required to parallel "monitoring" and "control measures" in the list. "Traffic flow management" is a compound noun phrase common in transport studies.
(hazard) substances	hazardous	Adjective needed before the noun "substances". "Hazard" (noun) → "hazardous" (adjective).
are (active) evaluating	actively	Adverb needed to modify the verb "evaluating". "Active" (adjective) → "actively" (adverb).
economic (feasible)	feasibility	Noun required after the adjective "economic". "Feasible" (adjective) → "feasibility" (noun). "Economic feasibility" = faisabilité économique.
potential in (reduce)	reducing	Gerund required after the preposition "in". Prepositions are always followed by V-ing.

Traps:

- **"conduct" → "have conducted" vs "conduct"**: both are grammatically possible, but the present perfect shows awareness of tense nuance (research as completed action with present relevance). "Conducted" alone (simple past) is less ideal because there is no specific past time marker.
- **"manage" → "management"**: many candidates write "managed" (past participle/adjective) or "managing" (gerund). But the parallel structure with "monitoring" (noun) and "control measures" (noun phrase) demands a noun: "management".

- **"feasible" → "feasibility"**: this is a difficult morphological transformation. Many candidates write "feasibleness" (which does not exist) or "feasibly" (adverb). Memorise: feasible → feasibility (like able → ability).

Language 2 — Circle the right option (3 marks)

Gap	Answer	Explanation
is (...) barring young children	systematically	Adverb required to modify the verb "barring". "Systematic" = adjective. "System" = noun. "Systematically" = adverb (de manière systématique).
primary (...)	caregivers	"Caregivers" = personnes qui prodiguent des soins. "Giftgivers" = personnes qui offrent des cadeaux. "Forgivers" = personnes qui pardonnent. The context is about mothers caring for their children.
many of (...)	whom	"Whom" is the object form used after a preposition ("of"). "Who" is a subject pronoun. "Whose" is a possessive pronoun. Here, "many of whom came to work" = dont beaucoup sont venues travailler.
to (...) them visas	grant	"Grant" = accorder, octroyer. "Grade" = noter, classer. "Grasp" = saisir, comprendre. The context is about the government giving visas.
reassured by their (...)	employers	"Employers" = employeurs. "Employees" = employés. "Employment" = emploi (noun). The women were reassured by the people who hired them — their employers.
in line (...)	with	Fixed expression: "in line with" = conformément à, en accord avec. "In line to" = en file d'attente pour. "In line for" = en lice pour.

Traps:

- **"systematically" vs "systematic"**: the word modifies the verb "barring", so an adverb (-ly) is required. Many candidates choose "systematic" because they see the adjective form more frequently.

- **"whom" vs "who"**: after a preposition ("of"), always use "whom" in formal English. "Many of who" is grammatically incorrect in standard written English.
- **"employers" vs "employees"**: candidates often confuse these two opposite words. Remember: the **employer** gives the job; the **employee** receives it. The women were workers (employees) who were reassured by their bosses (employers).

TIME MANAGEMENT (2-HOUR EXAM)

Phase	Time
Reading the text carefully + underlining key info	10 min
Reading Comprehension (Questions 1-6)	35 min
Writing 1 (World Teachers' Day — 4 lines)	10 min
Writing 2 (Forum post — 12 lines): draft + writing	30 min
Language (tenses + alternatives)	20 min
Proofreading (spelling, line count, grammar)	15 min

Specific advice for the Reading section:

- Always **underline** the sentence in the text that justifies your answer before writing it. This prevents invented answers.
- For Question 3 (FALSE statements), the detail you quote must **explicitly contradict** the statement — not just be a different fact.
- For Question 4 (synonyms), look for **idiomatic expressions** first before choosing literal paraphrases.

Specific advice for the Writing section:

- **Count lines** on your draft. Writing 1 = exactly 4 lines. Writing 2 = exactly 12 lines.
- In Writing 2, choose an invention you can **describe technically** (key features) and **analyse historically** (impact + 3 reasons).
- Use **signposting language**: "My first reason is...", "Secondly...", "Thirdly...", "In conclusion..." — this improves organisation marks.

✦ **Correction proposée — bacbymed** ✦

Document non officiel

Destiné à la méthodologie et aux arguments. La rédaction finale reste la responsabilité du candidat.